

Genuine Homes — Deployment Status & Handover

Full-stack free-tier deployment · Frontend on Vercel, Backend on Render

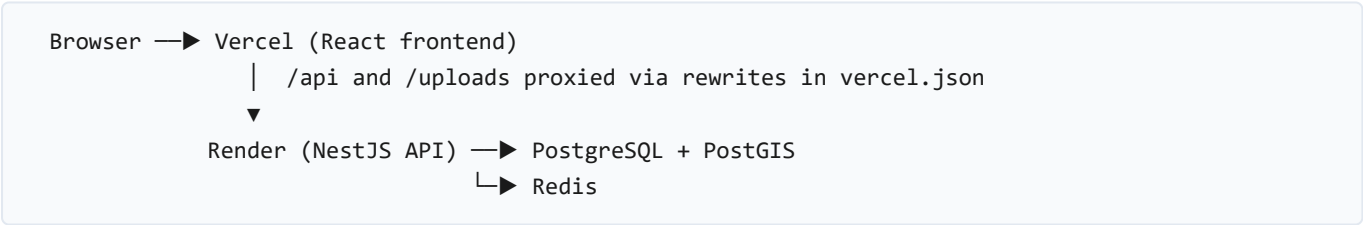
Prepared 2026-10-09 · Repository: github.com/Mundesdaniel/Genuine-Homes

1. Live Links

What	URL	Status
Backend API (NestJS)	https://genuine-homes-api.onrender.com	LIVE
API health check	.../api/health → <code>{"status":"ok"}</code>	200 OK
Frontend (React/Vite)	Temporary: <code>temporary-agile-willow-ney206b.vercel.app</code>	TEMPORARY — expires ~1h

⚠ The frontend URL is a temporary anonymous Vercel deploy and expires about an hour after each publish. To make it permanent (and auto-deploy on every `git push`), run `vercel login` once, then deploy to the real `genuine-homes` Vercel project. See section 5.

2. Architecture



The frontend proxies `/api` and `/uploads` to the Render API, so the browser only ever talks to one origin (the Vercel domain). This keeps the login/refresh cookie working without CORS or cross-site-cookie setup. Verified working: `GET <vercel-url>/api/health` → **200** through the proxy chain.

3. Current Status

Component	Status	Notes
Backend API (Render)	Live & healthy	Free tier: sleeps after ~15 min idle; first request then takes ~50s to wake.
PostgreSQL + PostGIS	Provisioned	Schema applied via <code>prisma migrate deploy</code> on boot.
Redis	Provisioned	Backs rate limiting, sessions, BullMQ queue.
Frontend (Vercel)	Live (temporary)	Needs permanent deploy — see section 5.

Demo data	Not seeded yet	Run <code>pnpm db:seed</code> in the Render Shell — see section 6.
Render env vars	To set	CORS_ORIGINS, PUBLIC_WEB_URL, PUBLIC_API_URL — see section 5.

4. What Was Fixed (Root Cause of the Failed Build)

The Render build was failing with `TS2307: Cannot find module './uploads/...'` (6 errors). The cause was a `.gitignore` rule — `uploads/`, intended for the *runtime* file-storage folder — that also matched the *source* module `apps/api/src/uploads/`. Those 9 source files existed locally but had never been pushed to GitHub, so Render could not compile them.

Fix (commit `9953c05` on `main`):

- Anchored the ignore rules to the real runtime paths (`/apps/api/uploads/` , `/apps/api/uploads-private/`) so they no longer swallow the source module.
- Committed the 9 missing `apps/api/src/uploads/` source files (uploads module, controller, constants, URL signer, and the storage strategies).

5. Finish the Deployment — Remaining Steps

Step A — Make the frontend permanent (Vercel)

1. In the project directory `apps/web` 's repo root, run `vercel login` → **Continue with GitHub**.
2. Link to the existing `genuine-homes` project and deploy to production: `vercel link` then `vercel --prod`.
3. **Important:** leave the Vercel **Root Directory empty** (repo root) so the root `vercel.json` is used. Do not set it to `apps/web` — that was the earlier dashboard misconfiguration.
4. Note the permanent URL (e.g. `https://genuine-homes.vercel.app`).

Step B — Set the Render environment variables

Render → `genuine-homes-api` → **Environment**, then **Save** (redeploys automatically):

Key	Value
<code>PUBLIC_API_URL</code>	<code>https://genuine-homes-api.onrender.com</code>
<code>PUBLIC_WEB_URL</code>	your permanent Vercel URL (from Step A)
<code>CORS_ORIGINS</code>	your permanent Vercel URL (from Step A)

Step C — Point `vercel.json` at the API (only if the URL differs)

If Render ever assigns a suffixed URL (e.g. `...-api-xyz.onrender.com`), update both occurrences in `vercel.json` and `git push`. Currently the API URL is exactly `https://genuine-homes-api.onrender.com` , which already matches `vercel.json` — **no change needed**.

6. Load Demo Data

The database is empty, so the home page lists no properties until seeded. Render → `genuine-homes-api` → **Shell** tab, then run:

```
pnpm db:seed
```

Demo accounts (password `Password123!` for all): `admin@genuinehomes.ug` , `pearl@estates.ug` , `roro@gmail.com` , and others.

7. Reference

Item	Value
Render API service id	<code>srv-db4c9prtqb8s73eqeibg</code>
Build command (Render)	<code>corepack enable && pnpm install --frozen-lockfile && pnpm build:shared && pnpm --filter @genuine-homes/api prisma:generate && pnpm --filter @genuine-homes/api build</code>
Start command (Render)	<code>pnpm --filter @genuine-homes/api prisma:deploy && pnpm --filter @genuine-homes/api start:prod</code>
Build command (Vercel)	<code>pnpm build:shared && pnpm --filter @genuine-homes/web build</code>
Vercel output directory	<code>apps/web/dist</code>
Payments	Mock gateway (<code>PAYMENT_GATEWAY=mock</code>)

8. Known Free-Tier Limitations

- **API sleeps** after ~15 min idle; first request after that takes ~50s to wake.
- **Ephemeral storage** — uploaded images reset on redeploy. Set `CLOUDINARY_URL` for persistence.
- **Live chat (WebSockets)** is not proxied by Vercel, so it is disabled in this setup. The rest of the app is unaffected.

Genuine Homes deployment handover · Generated 2026-10-09 · This document reflects the state at time of writing; the temporary frontend URL in section 1 will have changed if it expired before the permanent deploy was completed.